

Skills

Skills define **what kinds of actions a character can attempt**, not passive bonuses. Each skill grants explicit actions players may declare.

Use this format for every action: - **RLHF**: Required body anchors (R, L, H, F). - **Check**: Which skill roll is used. - **DC**: Typical target numbers for non-contested actions. - **On Success**: What the action does.

If an action is contested, the initiator rolls against a DC equal to the defender's average result for the relevant defensive skill/tier (meet or beat). Apply wound penalties from `wounds.md` using the action's required anchors.

Reaction Commitment Rule

By default, reactions do **not** require H.

- A reaction can only use anchors the character did **not** spend on their own turn.
- If a reaction needs L, R, or F, that anchor must be uncommitted from the character's last declared action.
- A reaction only requires H if a specific rule explicitly says it does.
- Dodge exception: spending F on normal movement/reposition does not consume Dodge.
- High-commitment footwork (**Sprint/Leap**) does consume Dodge unless a trait explicitly allows otherwise.

Skill Duration

Use these duration tags to pace actions without stopwatch tracking: - **Instant**: resolves in the current action/beat. - **Short**: about one focused action (can stretch under pressure). - **Extended**: multiple actions/beats; usually interrupted by danger. - **Scene**: remains relevant for the current scene unless fiction breaks it. - **Sustained**: lasts while actively maintained by the user.

Duration can shift by fiction: - Partial Critical may reduce one duration step for time-sensitive actions. - Legendary Success can reduce two steps when numerically sensible.

Skill Rank Dice

Use the skill's rank when rolling that skill:

Rank	Roll	Average Result	Contested DC (Rounded Up)
0	2d12	13	13
1	d10 + d12 + 2	14	14
2	2d10 + 4	15	15
3	d8 + d10 + 6	16	16
4	2d8 + 8	17	17
5	d6 + d8 + 10	18	18
6	2d6 + 12	19	19

Roll all dice, keep the two highest dice, then add the flat bonus. Leverage and Pressure from `core.md` still apply.

Contested Checks (Explicit Rule)

For any action marked contested: - Identify the defender's relevant skill tier. - Use that tier's **Average Result** from the table, rounded up, as the DC. - Initiator rolls normally and must meet or beat that DC.

Example: - Attacker Shove at Rank 2 rolls 2d10 + 4. - Defender has Rank 3 Athletics (d8 + d10 + 6), average 16. - Shove DC is 16, so attacker needs 16+.

Difficulty Benchmarks

DC	Difficulty
6	Trivial

DC	Difficulty
8	Easy
10	Average
12	Moderate
14	Hard
16	Very Hard
18+	Nearly Impossible

Guideline for declared actions: - If task is routine and low risk, no roll. - If task has danger, time pressure, or meaningful consequence, roll.

Rule of Cool DC Offset

To keep play fast and cinematic, apply a **-2 DC** offset to all **non-contested** DCs in this document. - Minimum adjusted DC is **6**. - Contested checks do **not** use this offset; they still use defender average rounded up.

Legendary Conversion Rule

Legendary Success: gain all listed Partial Critical effects and double all numeric values in those effects. The Guide may add one cinematic rider when fiction strongly supports it. ### Blindness Reference

Blindness and other scene conditions are defined in **status-effects.md**.

Athletics

Theme: Whole-body exertion, balance, force, terrain.

Core Actions

- **Sprint**

RLHF: F

Check: Athletics

Duration: Instant DC: 10 rough terrain, 12 crowded or unstable ground, 14+ hazards while sprinting.

On Success: Spend 1 stamina, gain +2 MR this round. Rank 2: first sprint each scene is free. Rank 4: first two are free. Rank 6: first three are free. **Partial Critical (choose one):** gain +2 MR this round; or ignore difficult terrain this move; or refund stamina cost. On Miss: Spend 1 stamina, but move normally.

- **Leap**

RLHF: FH

Check: Athletics

Duration: Instant DC by distance:

Horizontal: 8=5 ft, 10=8 ft, 12=10 ft, 14=12 ft, 16=15 ft, 18=20 ft, 20=25 ft.

Vertical: 8=1.5 ft, 10=2 ft, 12=3 ft, 14=4 ft, 16=6 ft, 18=8 ft, 20=10 ft.

On Success: Clear the gap/height.

Partial Critical (choose one): land in ideal footing; or add +5 ft horizontal or +1 ft vertical; or carry one adjacent ally/item without penalty. On Miss: Land short, hang at edge, or fall per terrain danger.

- **Climb**

RLHF: LRFH

Check: Athletics

Duration: Short DC: 8 ladder/rope, 12 rough wall, 16 slick wall, 18+ overhang/no holds.

On Success: Move up to half MR vertically (or full MR with fixed gear). **Partial Critical (choose one):** climb at full MR this action; or leave a stable route granting one advantage step to next climber; or ignore one hazard on the route.

- **Swim**

RLHF: LRFH

Check: Athletics

Duration: Short DC: 10 calm water, 12 current, 14 storm/drain pull, 16+ armor or injury in strong current.

On Success: Move half MR in water (full MR if unarmored and calm). **Partial Critical (choose one):** move full MR in water this action; or avoid breath loss/panic cost this round; or tow one creature one range step.

Contested / Tactical Actions

- **Shove / Bullrush**

RLHF: LHF

Check: Athletics (contested vs Athletics or Melee)

Duration: Instant **On Success:** Push target 5 ft or break their engagement. Beat by 4+: push 10 ft or knock prone.

Partial Critical (choose one): push +5 extra ft; or choose push, prone, and off-guard (instead of one); or you remain in strong stance and gain one advantage step on next grapple/shove.

- **Tumble**

RLHF: FH

Check: Athletics (contested vs opponent Melee)

Duration: Instant **On Success:** Move through threatened space without giving free melee response. **Partial**

Critical (choose one): move an additional 5 ft; or deny target reaction until end of round; or end in cover or flanking position.

- **Break Free**

RLHF: L(R)F

Check: Athletics (contested vs grappler Athletics/Melee)

Duration: Instant **On Success:** End one grapple/restraint lock on self.

Partial Critical (choose one): break one additional lock; or reposition 5 ft immediately; or impose +2 DC on grappler next maintain attempt. **Note:** H is not required for Break Free.

Environmental Actions

- **Navigate Dangerous Terrain**

RLHF: FH

Check: Athletics

Duration: Short DC: 10 rubble, 12 ice/mud, 14 collapsing footing, 16+ moving hazard.

On Success: Cross without falling or losing action tempo. **Partial Critical (choose one):** cross at full speed; or grant one ally one advantage step to follow same path; or avoid triggering latent terrain hazard.

Melee

Theme: Close-range violence, weapon control, physical dominance.

Core Actions

- **Strike**

RLHF: L(R)H

Option: Add R, to strike with two-handed weapon, or a weapon with the versatile quality. **Check:** Melee (vs target defense DC)

Duration: Instant **On Success:** Deal normal weapon wound(s). **Partial Critical (choose one):** gain +1 wound or force off-Guard; or shift 5 ft after hit; or deny one reaction from target this round.

- **Full Martial Strike**

RLHF: L(R)HF

Option: Add R, to strike with two-handed weapon, or a weapon with the versatile quality. **Check:** Melee vs target defense DC plus one step advantage. **Duration:** Instant **On Success:** Deal normal weapon wound(s). **Partial Critical (choose one):** add +1 wounds instead of baseline bonus; or force prone/off-Guard together; or immediately pressure a second adjacent target.

Defensive / Reactive Actions

- **Parry**

RLHF: L(R)H

Check: Melee (contested vs incoming melee roll)

Duration: Instant (Reaction) **On Success:** Negate hit. Beat by 4+: negate and gain +1 Leverage on next melee

action. **Partial Critical (choose one)**: immediately riposte at +2 DC; or disarm or bind on the deflection; or retain Guard against one additional approach.

- **Bind Weapon**

RLHF: LRHF

Check: Melee (contested)

Duration: Short On Success: Target cannot use bound weapon for its next action unless it wins a Break Free/Disengage contest. **Partial Critical (choose one)**: target needs two successes to free weapon; or you may reposition target 5 ft while maintaining bind; or next allied melee action gains one advantage step vs bound target.

Control Actions

- **Disarm**

RLHF: LHF

Check: Melee (contested)

Duration: Instant DC/Modifier: +2 DC if target uses two hands.

On Success: Target drops or loses ready access to weapon. **Partial Critical (choose one)**: weapon lands in a space you choose within 10 ft; or target also becomes off-Guard; or you may immediately seize or kick away the weapon.

- **Grapple**

RLHF: L or R (minimum one free limb)

Check: Melee or Athletics (contested)

Duration: Instant On Success: Establish one limb lock on target and enter Grappling state. **Partial Critical (choose one)**: apply one additional lock if you have a free limb; or inflict disoriented on target until end of next turn; or establish lock and reposition target 5 ft.

- **Maintain Grapple**

RLHF: L or R (locked limb must remain committed)

Check: Melee or Athletics (contested each round control is challenged)

Duration: Sustained On Success: Existing lock(s) remain in place with an option to commit additional limbs. **Partial Critical (choose one)**: add one new lock without separate grapple roll; or deal 1 wound from crushing control; or deny target all non-break reactions this round.

- **Throw**

RLHF: L or R (requires at least one active lock)

Check: Athletics or Melee (contested)

Duration: Instant On Success: Move target 5-10 ft and knock prone. Into hazard adds situational consequence. **Partial Critical (choose one)**: increase throw distance by 5 ft; or target takes +1 wound from impact; or you may remain standing and ready without losing stance.

Grapple Framework

- One committed limb restrains one target anchor (L, R, F, or H).
- Additional successful Grapple actions add additional locks by committing additional limbs.
- If a target has one or more locks on them, their speed is 0.
- A restrained anchor cannot be used for other actions; it can only be used to attempt **Break Free**.
- You cannot initiate a grapple with H, but H can be restrained.
- If you have no active lock on the target, attacks or grapple attempts without H are blind and use the Blind status rules from `status-effects.md`.
- Once you have at least one active lock on that target, you are not blind against them: additional grapples and attacks do not require H and take no blind penalty.
- If 3 of the target's limbs/anchors are restrained, the target is fully restrained; their remaining unrestrained limb/anchor is treated as unusable until they remove a lock.

Ranged

Theme: Precision, timing, and distance control.

Core Actions

- **Aim**

RLHF: LH

Check: Ranged

Duration: Short DC: 10 under light pressure, 12+ if target partially obscured.

On Success: Gain +1 Leverage die on next Fire/Called Shot before end of next turn. Partial Critical (choose one): also reduce one cover penalty tier; or carry aim benefit through your next turn if not fired; or gain one extra advantage step on next Fire/Called Shot.

- **Fire**

RLHF: L(R)H

Check: Ranged (vs target defense DC)

Duration: Instant On Success: Deal weapon wound(s). Partial Critical (choose one): conserve ammo; or force target off-Guard; or gain immediate 5 ft reposition without penalty.

- **Rapid Fire**

RLHF: L(R)H

Check: Ranged at +2 DC

Duration: Instant On Success: Two hits at -1 wound each (minimum 0), or split fire across two close targets. Partial Critical (choose one): both hits deal full weapon wounds; or suppress both targets you engaged; or do not suffer the rapid-fire accuracy increase next time this scene.

Tactical Actions

- **Suppress**

RLHF: L(R)H

Check: Ranged

Duration: Short DC: 12 doorway/choke, 14 open lane, 16+ wide lane.

On Success: Enemies crossing lane take +2 DC on move/advance or risk immediate attack. Partial Critical (choose one): cover a second adjacent lane; or duration extends one additional round; or targets crossing also lose one reaction.

- **Called Shot**

RLHF: LH

Check: Ranged

Duration: Instant DC Modifier: Core +0, Arms/Legs +2, Head +2 (per combat.md).

On Success: Apply wound to called location. Partial Critical (choose one): ignore called-shot modifier; or apply a status effect tied to hit location; or also force target to drop/lose one held item.

- **Cover Fire**

RLHF: LH

Check: Ranged

Duration: Short DC: 12

On Success: One ally moving this round ignores one enemy reaction from your covered direction. Partial Critical (choose one): affect one additional ally movement; or also pin target attention (+2 DC to their next offensive action); or conserve ammo on this covering action.

Thievery

Theme: Stealth, fine motor control, covert manipulation.

Stealth Procedure (Scene Rule)

- One successful stealth check can cover an entire scene.
- No additional stealth roll is needed unless the character takes an overt action or the fiction changes sharply.
- Overt actions include loud violence, open sprinting in view, breaking obvious cover, or direct interaction with a guarded target.
- When a new stealth check is required, resolve it immediately at the point of exposure risk.

NPCs track awareness as: - Relaxed -> Alert -> Suspicious -> Aware

On a failed stealth check: - Increase affected NPCs by one awareness step. - At **Aware**, they can actively engage, call out, and normal stealth is uncontestable.

Breaking **Aware** requires misdirection, not simple concealment: - Hiding behind nearby cover alone is insufficient if they already know your location. - You must create a believable false lead (noise, decoy movement, staged trail, etc.), then re-enter stealth. - Example: opening a manhole to imply escape there, then hiding under a tarp can justify a new stealth check.

Core Actions

- **Sneak**
RLHF: FH
Check: Thievery (opposed by observer Perception/Lore as appropriate)
Duration: Scene On Success: Move quietly without drawing attention. **Partial Critical (choose one)**: move an extra short distance while hidden; or leave no trace for immediate trackers; or create a brief opening for one ally to follow unseen.
- **Hide**
RLHF: FH
Check: Thievery
Duration: Scene DC: 10 cluttered area, 12 sparse cover, 14+ brief concealment windows.
On Success: Break line of sight and remain concealed until fiction changes. **Partial Critical (choose one)**: remain hidden despite brief exposure; or gain one advantage step on first action from hiding; or create a decoy sign that misdirects searchers.
- **Pick Lock**
RLHF: L(R)H
Check: Thievery
Duration: Short (Extended on hard locks) DC: 10 simple, 12 common, 14 quality lock, 16+ reinforced/security design.
On Success: Open lock quietly. **Partial Critical (choose one)**: open lock silently and quickly; or do not leave tamper evidence; or keep mechanism intact for clean relock.
- **Disable Device**
RLHF: L(R)H
Check: Thievery
Duration: Short (Extended on complex traps) DC: 12 known trap, 14 unfamiliar mechanism, 16+ complex/booby-trapped device.
On Success: Device is safely disarmed. **Partial Critical (choose one)**: disarm and learn reset method; or convert trap into one-use advantage for your side; or disable adjacent linked trigger as well.

Combat-Relevant Actions

- **Steal**
RLHF: LHF
Check: Thievery (contested vs target Awareness/Lore)
Duration: Instant On Success: Remove one small carried item. **Partial Critical (choose one)**: take one additional small item; or target does not realize loss until scene changes; or plant minor false clue while lifting item.
- **Sabotage**
RLHF: L(R)H
Check: Thievery
Duration: Short (Extended on reinforced targets) DC: 10 simple gear, 12 weapon, 14 armor fitting, 16+ reinforced mechanism.
On Success: Target object gains a failure condition on next use. **Partial Critical (choose one)**: failure effect is severe (breaks on first use); or sabotage remains hidden until triggered; or affect one adjacent connected component.
- **Plant Object**
RLHF: LHF
Check: Thievery
Duration: Short DC: 10 distracted target, 12 alert target, 14+ active search conditions.
On Success: Object remains unnoticed until searched or triggered. **Partial Critical (choose one)**: placement is undetectable without focused search; or object can be triggered remotely/simple condition; or also create false evidence trail.

Reaction Actions

- **Slip Away**
RLHF: FH
Check: Thievery (contested vs nearest threat Awareness)
Duration: Instant (Reaction) On Success: Exit engagement without immediate pursuit response. **Partial Critical (choose one)**: also break line of sight immediately; or pursuer chooses wrong direction; or you may move full speed while disengaging.
 - **Feign Innocence**
RLHF: H
Check: Thievery or Social
Duration: Short DC: 10 casual suspicion, 14 active accusation, 16+ direct witness.
On Success: Delay or redirect suspicion. **Partial Critical (choose one)**: shift suspicion to alternate plausible target; or buy one full round before renewed scrutiny; or observers lower alertness one tier.
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Lore

Theme: Knowledge, recognition, inference.

Core Actions

- **Recall Knowledge**
RLHF: H
Check: Lore
Duration: Instant DC: 8 common fact, 12 specialized, 16 obscure, 20+ forbidden/esoteric.
On Success: Learn a correct useful fact. **Partial Critical (choose one)**: gain one extra actionable fact; or fact includes immediate tactical application; or reduce next related check DC by 2.
- **Analyze Threat**
RLHF: H
Check: Lore
Duration: Short DC: 12
On Success: Learn one practical weakness, behavior trigger, or likely tactic. **Partial Critical (choose one)**: identify both weakness and behavior trigger; or grant one ally one advantage step vs this threat; or predict target next likely action.
- **Interpret Signs**
RLHF: FH
Check: Lore
Duration: Short DC: 10 clear clues, 12 mixed traces, 14+ degraded scene.
On Success: Establish what happened and direction/timing. **Partial Critical (choose one)**: determine exact timing and direction; or spot hidden secondary clue; or grant group one advantage step on next tracking/search action.

Preparatory Actions

- **Formulate Plan**
RLHF: H
Check: Lore
Duration: Short DC: 12
On Success: Grant one ally +1 Leverage die on first related action. **Partial Critical (choose one)**: grant two allies one advantage step each; or also reduce one foreseeable complication; or plan remains valid for one extra scene beat.
- **Predict Outcome**
RLHF: H
Check: Lore
Duration: Instant DC: 14
On Success: Guide states one likely consequence before commitment. **Partial Critical (choose one)**: receive best and worst likely branch; or gain one advantage step if acting on prediction immediately; or identify hidden cost before commitment.

Reactive Actions

- **Recognize Pattern**

RLHF: H

Check: Lore

Duration: Instant (Reaction) DC: 12 repeating behavior, 14 subtle setup, 16+ highly concealed pattern.

On Success: Act before trap/ambush fully resolves. **Partial Critical (choose one)**: interrupt the pattern before it triggers; or identify controller/source behind pattern; or grant party one free reposition before resolution.

Science

Theme: Medicine, engineering, chemistry, physics.

Core Actions

- **Diagnose**

RLHF: H

Check: Science

Duration: Short DC: 10 obvious injury/fault, 12 mixed symptoms, 14+ rare or hidden cause.

On Success: Identify root cause and best immediate intervention. **Partial Critical (choose one)**: determine root cause and best treatment path; or identify one hidden complication early; or grant one advantage step to next treatment/check.

- **Treat Wound**

RLHF: L(R)H

Check: Science

Duration: Short (Extended for severe trauma) DC: 10 basic first aid, 12 stabilize severe bleed, 14+ field surgery conditions.

On Success: Stabilize target and remove one immediate complication from the wound state. **Partial Critical (choose one)**: remove one additional immediate complication; or restore functional use of a recently impaired anchor for this scene; or treatment holds longer under pressure.

- **Engineer Bypass**

RLHF: L(R)H

Check: Science

Duration: Short (Extended on hardened systems) DC: 12 simple mechanism, 14 secured system, 16+ hardened system.

On Success: Temporarily bypass lockout/power/control issue. **Partial Critical (choose one)**: bypass lasts for full scene; or leave no forensic sign of bypass; or create safe fallback route if bypass collapses.

- **Analyze Substance**

RLHF: H

Check: Science

Duration: Short DC: 10 common substance, 14 mixed compounds, 18+ exotic/occult contamination.

On Success: Learn key properties, hazard, and safe handling. **Partial Critical (choose one)**: identify exact composition and immediate antidote/neutralizer route; or detect trace contamination source; or grant one advantage step on next handling/use.

- **Improvise Tool**

RLHF: L(R)H

Check: Science

Duration: Short DC: 12 simple, 14 precise, 16+ high-pressure improvised build.

On Success: Create temporary tool usable for a single action. **Partial Critical (choose one)**: tool functions for full scene instead of one use; or tool grants one extra advantage step on first use; or build time is halved.

Social

Theme: Influence, pressure, and presence.

Core Actions

- **Persuade**
RLHF: H
Check: Social (contested for resistant targets)
Duration: Short DC: 10 receptive, 12 uncertain, 14 resistant, 16+ hostile.
On Success: Target accepts a reasonable request or concession. **Partial Critical (choose one)**: target also offers useful concession; or effect lasts one additional scene beat; or one bystander becomes favorable too.
- **Deceive**
RLHF: H
Check: Social (contested vs target Lore/Social)
Duration: Short On Success: Target believes false claim until contradictory evidence appears. **Partial Critical (choose one)**: lie survives immediate verification attempt; or target repeats lie to others as truth; or gain one advantage step on follow-up social action.
- **Intimidate**
RLHF: HF
Check: Social
Duration: Instant DC: 10 weaker foe, 14 equal foe, 16+ disciplined foe.
On Success: Target hesitates, yields space, or accepts short-term compliance. **Partial Critical (choose one)**: target withdraws or yields space immediately; or target loses next reaction; or nearby weaker witness also hesitates.
- **Command**
RLHF: H
Check: Social
Duration: Instant DC: 10 ally subordinate, 12 ally peer under stress, 14+ contested authority.
On Success: One ally may immediately adjust position or clear a fear hesitation. **Partial Critical (choose one)**: ally acts immediately and gains one advantage step; or order also steadies fear by 1; or two allies can take minor reposition instead of one.

Tactical / Combat-Adjacent Actions

- **Distract**
RLHF: H
Check: Social
Duration: Instant DC: 12
On Success: Target loses one reaction or suffers +2 DC on next action. **Partial Critical (choose one)**: target loses both reaction and focus bonus; or create opening granting one ally one advantage step; or target misreads your next move.
- **Provoke**
RLHF: H
Check: Social (contested)
Duration: Instant On Success: Target commits to an aggressive or suboptimal action chosen by Guide within fiction. **Partial Critical (choose one)**: target commits to a predictable line; or target suffers +2 DC on defense until end of turn; or nearby enemies hesitate before assisting.
- **Rally**
RLHF: H
Check: Social
Duration: Short DC: 12 in cover/safety, 14 under active threat, 16+ panic conditions.
On Success: One ally reduces fear by 1 step or gains +1 Leverage on next defense. **Partial Critical (choose one)**: affect one additional ally; or also clear one minor complication tied to panic/fatigue; or all rallied allies gain one advantage step on next defense.

Consequence-Driven Actions

- **Posture**
RLHF: HF
Check: Social
Duration: Scene DC: 12
On Success: Establish local dominance; first opposed social check this scene gains +1 Leverage. **Partial Critical**

(choose one): establish dominance over a wider audience; or first two opposed social checks this scene gain one advantage step; or opponent must answer your framing or cede ground.

- **Undermine**

RLHF: H

Check: Social

Duration: Short DC: 12 fragile cohesion, 14 disciplined group, 16+ fanatic loyalty.

On Success: Reduce enemy morale/cohesion and impose +2 DC on their next coordinated action. **Partial Critical** (choose one): enemy coordination penalty lasts one extra round; or fracture one key relationship in opposing group; or their next leader command carries +2 DC.

Magic

Theme: Controlled violation of natural rules. Availability is setting-dependent.

Core Actions

- **Cast**

RLHF: LH

Check: Magic

Duration: Instant DC: Set by spell profile in `spells.md`.

On Success: Spell manifests as intended. **Partial Critical** (choose one): add one minor rider effect consistent with spell type; or reduce immediate backlash by one step; or gain one advantage step on next Sustain/Focus.

- **Sustain**

RLHF: H

Check: Magic

Duration: Sustained DC: 10 stable effect, 12 contested zone, 14+ high-pressure scene.

On Success: Ongoing effect continues without escalation. **Partial Critical** (choose one): extend duration by one tier; or free one anchor normally tied up by sustain strain; or stabilize effect against one disruption source.

- **Focus**

RLHF: H

Check: Magic

Duration: Instant DC: 12

On Success: Gain +1 Leverage die on next magic action or reduce backlash severity by one step. **Partial Critical** (choose one): gain two advantage steps on next magic action; or also cancel one pending backlash complication; or retain Guard-equivalent awareness against one approach.

Defensive / Reactive Actions

- **Counter**

RLHF: LH

Check: Magic (contested vs caster)

Duration: Instant (Reaction) On Success: Interrupt incoming magical effect. **Partial Critical** (choose one): counter and reflect minor portion of effect; or counter without losing your next planned action; or impose +2 DC on enemy next cast.

- **Dispel**

RLHF: LH

Check: Magic

Duration: Instant DC: 12 minor effect, 14 sustained effect, 16+ entrenched ritual effect.

On Success: End or suppress target effect. **Partial Critical** (choose one): dispel and learn signature/source; or suppress nearby related effect for one round; or convert residual energy to one advantage step for ally.

- **Ward**

RLHF: LH

Check: Magic

Duration: Scene DC: 12 personal ward, 14 area ward, 16+ layered ward.

On Success: Protected target gains +2 DC versus one defined threat category. **Partial Critical** (choose one): ward covers one extra adjacent target/zone; or ward gains one additional trigger/use; or ward also imposes minor backlash on first attacker.

Risk Actions

- **Overchannel**

RLHF: LH

Check: Magic at +2 DC

Duration: Instant On Success: Increase one spell parameter (range, duration, or potency) by one tier.

Partial Critical (choose one): gain two spell parameter tiers instead of one; or avoid immediate backlash step increase; or retain one free follow-up Focus this round. On Miss: Spell still manifests in type, but backlash escalates one step.

- **Ritualize**

RLHF: LRFH

Check: Magic

Duration: Extended DC: 14 prepared circle/text, 16 partial prep, 18+ rushed/hostile conditions.

On Success: Complete long-form effect with reduced immediate backlash. Partial Critical (choose one): ritual time reduced by one tier; or effect gains strong stability and duration; or participants gain one advantage step on immediate aftermath actions.

Design Notes

- Skills define available actions, not static passive bonuses.
- RLHF anchor commitment keeps consequences grounded in body state.
- Rank changes both dice quality and flat bonus, making skill growth reliable under pressure.
- For edge cases, use the nearest action here as baseline, then tune DC by fiction.